TEACHER GUIDE

AQA A-level Business (7138)

People management: recruitment and training



3.2 Unit: Managing people and operations
3.2.1 People management: recruitment and training

A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise people management: recruitment and training on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

The lesson

45-minute setting

Setup	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Final questions

EVERY ROUND

Firm decisions
3 min

→

Deals
4½–5 min

→

Topic tasks
4 min

→

B2B deal
2½ min
from Round 2

LESSON SETTINGS

30 min	45 min	60 min	75 min

What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



CEO

Staff · Sabotage from Round 2



Finance

Capital & Loans · Investments



Sales & Marketing

Marketing



Operations

Seasonal stock

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same. Your Live screen shows each task and every firm's answer.

1 Promotion risk

Round 1

You promote your best salesperson to sales manager.

Which risk is most likely?

- **A** They do not know the firm
- **B** High advertising costs
- **C** Staff see no route to promotion
- **D** You must replace your top seller

ANSWER

✓ You must replace your top seller

Why: Internal promotion leaves a gap where the best seller used to sell.

2 Cost of turnover

Round 1

Labour turnover at your firm doubled this year.

Which two costs are most likely to rise?

- **A** Hiring and training new staff
- **B** Lost sales while new staff learn
- **C** Overtime to cover idle staff
- **D** Pensions for long-serving staff
- **E** Redundancy pay

ANSWER

✓ Hiring and training new staff
✓ Lost sales while new staff learn

Why: Each leaver must be replaced and trained, and new staff sell less at first.

3 Labour turnover

Round 2

Three branches: staff on average, and how many left this year.

Order by labour turnover, lowest first?

- **A** 50 staff, 10 leavers
- **B** 24 staff, 6 leavers
- **C** 80 staff, 12 leavers

ANSWER

1. 80 staff, 12 leavers
2. 50 staff, 10 leavers
3. 24 staff, 6 leavers

Why: Turnover 15%, 20%, 25%: the fewest leavers is the highest rate.

Topic tasks

4 Staff to recruit

Round 2

Plan the workshop staff for next year.

How many must you recruit?

Technicians needed next year	**23 staff**
Technicians now	**20 staff**
Labour turnover a year	**25%**

ANSWER

8 staff

25% of 20 = 5 leave; 23 − 15 = 8

Why: Recruit for growth and for the staff who leave.

5 Full or part time

Round 3

Most buyers come on Saturdays; weekdays are quiet.

Which staffing should you choose, and why?

A Part-time staff for weekends

B More full-time staff all week

ANSWER

✓ Part-time staff for weekends

Why: Part-time staff match the cost of staff to the busy times.

6 Why a role-play

Round 3

Applicants must sell a car to a manager in a role-play before any job offer.

Why is this better than an interview alone?

A It attracts more applicants

B It replaces induction training

C It tests the skill the job needs

D It is cheaper than an interview

ANSWER

✓ It tests the skill the job needs

Why: A role-play shows how well each applicant sells, so selection is more reliable.

Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions on people management: recruitment and training. They come from these 8 questions.

1. A dealer promotes its best salesperson to sales manager instead of advertising outside. What is a main advantage?
   ✔ **The person already knows the business**

2. A workshop needs an EV specialist no current employee can become quickly. Why recruit externally?
   ✔ **It brings skills the firm does not have**

3. A document lists the duties and reporting line of a service adviser. What is it?
   ✔ **A job description**

4. Which item belongs in a person specification for a technician?
   ✔ **A recognised vehicle technician qualification**

5. What is induction training for a newly hired sales adviser?
   ✔ **Introducing the firm, its rules and systems**

6. Technicians learn a new diagnostic system at the maker’s training centre for three days. Which type of training is this?
   ✔ **Off-the-job training**

7. Training six technicians costs £900 each plus £350 of lost output each. The dealer expects £9,000 extra profit in the first year. What is the first-year net gain?
   ✔ **£1,500**

8. A dealer’s new recruits keep leaving within three months. Which change to selection is most likely to help?
   ✔ **Use a realistic work trial before offering the job**